



Manage and execute a detailed tour itinerary

D2.TTO.CL4.09

Trainee Manual



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Introduction to trainee manual

To the Trainee

Congratulations on joining this course. This Trainee Manual is one part of a 'toolbox' which is a resource provided to trainees, trainers and assessors to help you become competent in various areas of your work.

The 'toolbox' consists of three elements:

- A Trainee Manual for you to read and study at home or in class
- A Trainer Guide with Power Point slides to help your Trainer explain the content of the training material and provide class activities to help with practice
- An Assessment Manual which provides your Assessor with oral and written questions and other assessment tasks to establish whether or not you have achieved competency.

The first thing you may notice is that this training program and the information you find in the Trainee Manual seems different to the textbooks you have used previously. This is because the method of instruction and examination is different. The method used is called Competency based training (CBT) and Competency based assessment (CBA). CBT and CBA is the training and assessment system chosen by ASEAN (Association of South-East Asian Nations) to train people to work in the tourism and hospitality industry throughout all the ASEAN member states.

What is the CBT and CBA system and why has it been adopted by ASEAN?

CBT is a way of training that concentrates on what a worker can do or is required to do at work. The aim is of the training is to enable trainees to perform tasks and duties at a standard expected by employers. CBT seeks to develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes (or recognise the ones the trainee already possesses) to achieve the required competency standard. ASEAN has adopted the CBT/CBA training system as it is able to produce the type of worker that industry is looking for and this therefore increases trainees chances of obtaining employment.

CBA involves collecting evidence and making a judgement of the extent to which a worker can perform his/her duties at the required competency standard. Where a trainee can already demonstrate a degree of competency, either due to prior training or work experience, a process of 'Recognition of Prior Learning' (RPL) is available to trainees to recognise this. Please speak to your trainer about RPL if you think this applies to you.

What is a competency standard?

Competency standards are descriptions of the skills and knowledge required to perform a task or activity at the level of a required standard.

242 competency standards for the tourism and hospitality industries throughout the ASEAN region have been developed to cover all the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in the following occupational areas:

- Housekeeping
- Food Production
- Food and Beverage Service
- Front Office

- Travel Agencies
- Tour Operations.

All of these competency standards are available for you to look at. In fact you will find a summary of each one at the beginning of each Trainee Manual under the heading 'Unit Descriptor'. The unit descriptor describes the content of the unit you will be studying in the Trainee Manual and provides a table of contents which are divided up into 'Elements' and 'Performance Criteria'. An element is a description of one aspect of what has to be achieved in the workplace. The 'Performance Criteria' below each element details the level of performance that needs to be demonstrated to be declared competent.

There are other components of the competency standard:

- *Unit Title*: statement about what is to be done in the workplace
- *Unit Number*: unique number identifying the particular competency
- *Nominal hours*: number of classroom or practical hours usually needed to complete the competency. We call them 'nominal' hours because they can vary e.g. sometimes it will take an individual less time to complete a unit of competency because he/she has prior knowledge or work experience in that area.

The final heading you will see before you start reading the Trainee Manual is the 'Assessment Matrix'. Competency based assessment requires trainees to be assessed in at least 2 – 3 different ways, one of which must be practical. This section outlines three ways assessment can be carried out and includes work projects, written questions and oral questions. The matrix is designed to show you which performance criteria will be assessed and how they will be assessed. Your trainer and/or assessor may also use other assessment methods including 'Observation Checklist' and 'Third Party Statement'. An observation checklist is a way of recording how you perform at work and a third party statement is a statement by a supervisor or employer about the degree of competence they believe you have achieved. This can be based on observing your workplace performance, inspecting your work or gaining feedback from fellow workers.

Your trainer and/or assessor may use other methods to assess you such as:

- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Role plays
- Log books
- Group projects
- Practical demonstrations.

Remember your trainer is there to help you succeed and become competent. Please feel free to ask him or her for more explanation of what you have just read and of what is expected from you and best wishes for your future studies and future career in tourism and hospitality.

Unit descriptor

Manage and execute a detailed tour itinerary

This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to Manage and execute a detailed tour itinerary in a range of settings within the travel industries workplace context.

Unit Code:

D2.TTO.CL4.09

Nominal Hours:

80

Element 1: Prepare for tour itinerary

Performance Criteria

- 1.1 Identify the requirements in the itinerary
- 1.2 Clarify requirements relating to the itinerary
- 1.3 Plan tour in accordance with briefing information
- 1.4 Identify tour-related risks
- 1.5 Develop contingency plans for risks
- 1.6 Confirm reserved tour components

Element 2: Conduct departure-related activities

Performance Criteria

- 2.1 Greet tour group members
- 2.2 Complete outstanding customer details
- 2.3 Distribute tour-related information
- 2.4 Provide tour briefing
- 2.5 Provide last-minute confirmations, payments and booking details to suppliers, providers and carriers

Element 3: Brief tour staff

Performance Criteria

- 3.1 Provide tour details to tour staff
- 3.2 Provide resources to support tour

Element 4: Liaise with external industry colleagues throughout the tour

- 4.1 Liaise with industry personnel to facilitate tour implementation
- 4.2 Request assistance, where appropriate
- 4.3 Make on tour agreements with organisations to respond to issues arising

Element 5: Manage on tour itinerary

Performance Criteria

- 5.1 Facilitate conduct of the tour schedule
- 5.2 Advise tour staff regarding issues arising
- 5.3 Re-plan itinerary as required
- 5.4 Maintain contact with those responsible for resolving on tour issues
- 5.5 Advise industry colleagues regarding tour changes
- 5.6 Maintain regular contact with tour group
- 5.7 Monitor the tour area

Element 6: Deal with unexpected events

Performance Criteria

- 6.1 Initiate contingency planning actions
- 6.2 Support tour group leaders/guides
- 6.3 Research and suggest additional action to be taken
- 6.4 Make arrangements in response to identified emergencies
- 6.5 Handle media interest
- 6.6 Amend tour itinerary as required

Element 7: Finalise tour

Performance Criteria

- 7.1 Solicit feedback from tour group members
- 7.2 Solicit feedback from suppliers, providers and carriers
- 7.3 Debrief tour staff
- 7.4 Prepare tour report
- 7.5 Share information with suppliers, providers and carriers
- 7.6 Archive information for future reference

Assessment matrix

Showing mapping of Performance Criteria against Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions

The Assessment Matrix indicates three of the most common assessment activities your Assessor may use to assess your understanding of the content of this manual and your performance - Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions. It also indicates where you can find the subject content related to these assessment activities in the Trainee Manual (i.e. under which element or performance criteria). As explained in the Introduction, however, the assessors are free to choose which assessment activities are most suitable to best capture evidence of competency as they deem appropriate for individual students.

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 1: Prepare for tour itinerary				
1.1	Identify the requirements in the itinerary	1.1	1-2	1
1.2	Clarify requirements relating to the itinerary	1.2	3	2
1.3	Plan tour in accordance with briefing information	1.3	4-5	3
1.4	Identify tour-related risks	1.4+1.5	6-7	4
1.5	Develop contingency plans for risks	1.4+1.5	8	5
1.6	Confirm reserved tour components	1.6	9-10	6
Element 2: Conduct departure-related activities				
2.1	Greet tour group members	2.1+2.4	11	7
2.2	Complete outstanding customer details	2.2	12-13	8
2.3	Distribute tour-related information	2.3	14	9
2.4	Provide tour briefing	2.1+2.4	15-16-17	10
2.5	Provide last-minute confirmations, payments and booking details to suppliers, providers and carriers	2.5	18-19	11
Element 3: Brief tour staff				
3.1	Provide tour details to tour staff	3.1+3.2	20-21	12
3.2	Provide resources to support tour	3.1+3.2	22-23	13

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 4: Liaise with external industry colleagues throughout the tour				
4.1	Liaise with industry personnel to facilitate tour implementation	4.1	24	14
4.2	Request assistance, where appropriate	4.2	25	15
4.3	Make on tour agreements with organisations to respond to issues arising	4.3	26-27	16
Element 5: Manage on tour itinerary				
5.1	Facilitate conduct of the tour schedule	5.1+5.2+ 5.4+5.5+ 5.6+5.7	28	17
5.2	Advise tour staff regarding issues arising	5.1+5.2+ 5.4+5.5+ 5.6+5.7	29	18
5.3	Re-plan itinerary as required	5.3	30-31	19
5.4	Maintain contact with those responsible for resolving on tour issues	5.1+5.2+5. 4+ 5.5+5.6+5. 7	32	20
5.5	Advise industry colleagues regarding tour changes	5.1+5.2+ 5.4+5.5+ 5.6+5.7	33	21
5.6	Maintain regular contact with tour group	5.1+5.2+ 5.4+5.5+ 5.6+5.7	34	22
5.7	Monitor the tour area	5.1+5.2+ 5.4+5.5+ 5.6+5.7	35	23
Element 6: Deal with unexpected events				
6.1	Initiate contingency planning actions	6.1+6.2+6. 3+6.4	36	24
6.2	Support tour group leaders/guides	6.1+6.2+6. 3+6.4	37	25
6.3	Research and suggest additional action to be taken	6.1+6.2+6. 3+6.4	38	26
6.4	Make arrangements in response to identified emergencies	6.1+6.2+6. 3+6.4	39-40	27
6.5	Handle media interest	6.5	41	28

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
6.6	Amend tour itinerary as required	Refer to 5.3	30-31	20
Element 7: Finalise tour				
7.1	Solicit feedback from tour group members	7.1+7.2	42	30
7.2	Solicit feedback from suppliers, providers and carriers	7.1+7.2	43	31
7.3	Debrief tour staff	7.3	44	32
7.4	Prepare tour report	7.4+7.5	45	33
7.5	Share information with suppliers, providers and carriers	7.4+7.5	46	34
7.6	Archive information for future reference	7.6	47-48	35

Glossary

Term	Explanation
Body language	Non-verbal communication
Compliance	Something that does comply with what is required
Duty of Care	Responsibility for the safety of the customer
Duty of care	Responsibility for the safety of the customer
Emergency	A serious, unexpected, and often dangerous situation requiring immediate action
Inclusions	Items such as products, services, activities, merchandise etc. included in a tour/package
Itinerary	A schedule for a tour showing what tour group members will be doing, where they will be going, and the times for each activity
Liability	Being legally responsible
OHS	Occupational health and safety
Policy	Concise formal statement which indicates how an organization will act in a particular area of its operation
Procedure	A particular way of doing things. Normally in reference to implementing a policy.
Q&A	Question & Answer session
Scope of authority	The authority given you by management to make on-the-spot decisions on behalf of the organisation without reference to anyone else
Scope of authority	The authority given to you by management to make decisions and take action on behalf of the venue without recourse to management
SOP	Standard Operating Procedure
Tour brief	Information provided to the tourist guide relating to the guests, the itinerary and any special request prior to the tour

Term	Explanation
Tour briefing	Information session provided by the tour guide to tour group members relating to the tour content, itinerary, rules etc.
Tour component	Element part of a tour
Tour daily log	Internal document keeping a record of all daily tour events from completion of itinerary to emergencies
Tour report	Information provided by the tourist guide on completion of the tour detailing incidents, hazards, customer feedback and recommendations
Transfer	Travel from point-to-point: such as airport to hotel; cruise centre to airport
Word of Mouth	WOM - recommendations made by people in an informal manner

Please note that this Glossary is not exhaustive. Some words or phrases may also appear in the Glossary that do not appear in the training resources but have been made available to the Trainer as an extra resource if and when required.

Element 1:

Prepare for tour itinerary

1.1 Identify the requirements in the itinerary

Introduction

The tour itinerary is the road map for any tour. It describes the traveller's route and direction of travel. It also lists travel arrangements in the date of order that they are taken, and often lists them day by day.

Itinerary requirements

The itinerary requirements include all products, services and activities required duration of the trip including:

- Destination: domestic, international
- Length of tour: short or extended
- Dates and times pertinent to transport, meals and all activities
- Carriers, transport such as:
 - Domestic and international flights
 - Rail
 - Coach, mini bus
 - Car, bicycle
 - Ferry, boat, cruise ship
 - Inclusions such as:
 - Airport transfers
 - Accommodation
 - Meals
 - Activities, options such as:
 - Sightseeing
 - Entry to attractions: natural parks, historical sites, museums, art galleries
 - Entry to events: shows, theatre, sporting events
 - Free time
- Recent changes made to:
 - Destinations such as a park closure due to adverse weather conditions
 - Activities: a temple is temporarily closed for renovation and the visit will be replaced by a museum visit in the same area



- Booking details such as:
 - Customers details:
 - Name and contact details
 - Passport detail, travel documents such as insurance details (if applicable)
 - Visa (if applicable)
 - Record of payments received for the tour:
 - Full payment for accommodation when only a holding deposit had been prepaid
 - Payment for optional activities the customers have chosen to undertake.



1.2 Clarify requirements relating to the itinerary

Introduction

To ensure the smooth delivery of the tour, it is essential that all requirements of the various aspects of the incoming tour are clarified and verified.

The first step of this process is to check all customers' required information, from their personal details to their personal profile and requirements together with funds paid.

Requirements clarification include:

Compliance with/to financial requirements:

Every organisation will have their own financial standard operating procedures and the policies might vary from one organisation to another. However the following points will need to be checked in accordance with the publicised tour terms and conditions:

- Payment of deposit required to secure the booking
- Full payment paid within the organisation timeline.



Finalisation of customers' preferences:

For example, the tour itinerary includes one half day activity when the customers can choose between:

- A visit to an animal sanctuary: Lanjak-Entimau orang-utan sanctuary in Saba, east Malaysia
- A tour to a world heritage site such as Ha Long Bay in Viet Nam or Angkor Wat in Cambodia.

The customers need to provide the information with enough lead time for the organisation to manage those options and liaise with the relevant supplier of products and services to confirm the number of visitors to each venue.

Customers follow up:

Potential customers who have failed to:

- Confirm their tour participation after initially contacting your organisation to express interest in the tour
- And/or have not paid for the tour whether it is in regards to the initial deposit and/or final payment.

Only when all the information just covered is finalised can the tour itinerary be finalised and suppliers, providers of products and service be contacted with the information they need such as final numbers, preferences.

Following the confirmation of the customers details and options preferences, the next step is to plan the tour in accordance with the briefing information.

1.3 Plan tour in accordance with briefing information

Introduction

The briefing information serves as the platform to prepare the tour and contact the carriers, suppliers, providers of the products and services required for the successful completion of the tour.

Carriers, suppliers and providers management

Advising existing carriers, suppliers and providers

All arrangements now need to be confirmed with each organisation you usually work with in order to organise the tour and may include:

- Carriers:
 - Plane
 - Coach
 - Train
 - Car, bicycle
 - Cruise ship, boat
- The information they all require is:
 - Arrival, departure times, flights, transport route
 - Total number of passengers
 - Total number of pieces of luggage
 - Transfer arrangements
 - Special needs passenger such as vision impaired, restricted mobility
 - Special dietary requirements if meals are provided during voyage: gluten free, vegetarian, nut allergy
- Suppliers and providers of products and services: they will range from accommodation to restaurants, sites, attractions to be visited, and activities to take place. The information required is very similar to above and should include:
 - Arrival, departure time
 - Number of customers
 - Special request for accommodation such a quiet room, a family having requested interconnecting rooms: 2 adults plus 2 kids travelling together
 - Special dietary request: gluten free, vegetarian, nut allergy
 - Special need customer such as vision impaired, restricted mobility.



Seeking input and information from existing carriers, suppliers and providers

Depending on the nature of the tour and its inclusions, you might have to clarify some information and, or ask for advice such as:

- Accommodation: availability of interconnecting rooms, quiet rooms, near lift
- Dietary requirements: can a vegan customer be accommodated?
- Confirmation of provided equipment for a diving activity.

Sourcing new carriers, suppliers and providers

In order to execute the itinerary, it might also be necessary to source a new carrier, supplier and provider. The reasons might be:

- The closure or cessation of business of one of your providers such as a restaurant
- A supplier excessive and sudden price increase forcing the organisation to look for a new supplier with more reasonable prices in order to continue to provide the same products or service at the same price to their customers
- The itinerary is a new itinerary with new inclusions such as bird watching in a national park, thus requiring a specialist guide.

Reservations management

To effectively manage a tour, all relevant information must be passed on to the relevant carriers in regards to transport arrangements and, or handling agent. A handling agent, also called Destination Management Company, is a business who has extensive local knowledge expertise, network and provide 'on the ground' services such as

- Meeting and greeting customers and issuing of documentation
- Transport and transfer
- Hotel accommodation, restaurant bookings
- Tours
- When working with a handling agent, you need to
- Make the booking
- Check that the tour inclusions are:
 - Available: some tour inclusions might not be available all year due to:
 - Religious holidays
 - Seasonal limitations such as low season, low temperature
 - Accessible: are the roads leading to a wide life reserve opened after exceptional rainfall.



Tour content management

All tour itinerary details need to be checked and confirmed with the relevant carrier, supplier, provider in order to:

- Ensure integration of:
 - Destinations: sites to be visited, places to stay
 - Carriers: confirmation of means of transport: coach, private car, rail, bus
 - Activities: ranging from scheduled city walking tour to diving or para sailing
- Tour promotion inclusions availability: are all the advertised tour inclusions still available? This is a challenging area when it covers inclusions such as observing koalas in the wild in Australia, whale watching both in Australia and other countries.
- An increasing number of organisation do publicise on brochures, website the 'right to change the tour and its inclusions according to road conditions or other circumstances beyond control': see one example below:
 - <http://www.thetraveller.com.au/terms.html>.



Customers' needs and management of expectations

Customer satisfaction is the key to a successful business. At this planning stage of the tour, special attention should be paid when confirming arrangements to:

- Align with specific customers' requests. This can be as simple as confirming a request for a quiet room in regards to accommodation
- Generating alternatives for options and expectations that cannot be accommodated: the tour promotes an evening cultural show featuring local dances and upon contacting the organiser, you are told the group of dancers is touring overseas for 3 months. The organiser and you need to offer an alternative option to the customers such as a local well known puppet show or martial arts display
- Make arrangements to cater for individual needs and preferences. This ranges from advising all concerned parties that one of the customers is extremely allergic to nuts to another customer having a phobia of lift in regards to room accommodation allocation.

1.4 Identify tour-related risks

Introduction

Safety and risk management is becoming an increasingly important matter as more and more people travel in their own country or overseas. Potential risks associated with a tour need to be clearly identified as part of the tour planning phase.

Tour related risks

They can be divided into

- External risks factors
- Risks factors specific to the tour.

They vary according to the type of tour, itinerary being planned and include:

- Length of the tour: short or extended
- Type of tour and itinerary such as:
- General sight seeing
- Adventure and recreational
- Cultural, educational, historic
- Eco tour
- Cruise program.



Potential external risks factors: they are numerous, difficult to predict and might include:

- Political factors:
 - General political instability due to a recent change of government or impending elections
 - Tourists being regularly targeted in relation to theft
- Environmental conditions, weather and seasonal factors:
 - Natural condition such as for trekking tours to Himalaya or Macchu Piccu in Peru
 - Ecological considerations in regarding to the impact of camping tours in national park such as rubbish disposal management
 - Fire risk in specific forest areas during the hot dry season months
 - Typhoon risk in some areas of Asia
 - Potential roads closure in winter in mountainous areas due to heavy rain or snow.

Potential risks associated with the tour itinerary

Being fully informed in regards to all aspects of the itinerary is paramount to identify potential risks in regards to the course of the itinerary. The following factors need to be examined:

- General infrastructure support such as:
 - Government agencies advice: most countries have a travel advisory and consular services where the latest information is available in regards to how safe it is to travel In Australia for example the smart traveller website is always up to date and very informative:
 - www.smarttraveller.gov.au/
 - Medical assistance availability
 - Police services availability
 - The development level and accessibility of tourism authorities and tourism businesses
 - Hospitality resources such as accommodation availability and standard, restaurants, food and beverage facilities availability and standards in regards to:
 - OHS (Occupational safety and Security)
 - HACCP (Food safety)
- Access and transport such as:
 - Obtaining permits in order to visit designated sites
 - Complying to specific requirements such as travelling in a convoy at specified times as is required to visit the temple of Abu Simbel in lower Egypt
 - Easy access to transport from coaches to train, cars, boats
 - Safety of those modes of transport:
 - Completing pre departure vehicle safety checklist
 - Ensuring all required equipment is in vehicle from spare petrol to water, if applicable
 - Ensuring mode of transport matches the guests expectations and physical ability (four wheel drive vehicle is less comfortable than a mini bus)
 - Tour duration: half day to extended tour as it directly impacts on risk level
- Tour activities risk rating:
 - Low such as a walking
 - Medium such as snorkelling
 - High such as diving where a professionally trained staff member will have the responsibility to ensure tour group members are fit to complete the activity, have a current diving license and have completing the disclaimer form
- Time management: if the itinerary is very tight there might be a risk of running late



- Risks in regards to individuals group members themselves ranging from:
 - Level of fitness not matching the activities
 - Low mobility, disability impacting on the itinerary, time needed to complete activity
 - Language: provide translated hand out, guide speaking the language
 - Cultural issues in regards to dress code such as women wearing shorts in the Middle East: this needs to be managed with sensitivity by all concerned parties
 - Food allergies such as nuts, fish and shellfish allergies
- Last but not least potential service delivery difficulty needs to be considered and can range from:
 - Tour location/s as the more remote the location, the more challenging it will be to keep the service standards
 - The potential volatile and somehow predictable state of transport: France is well known for the frequency of impromptu transport strikes in the summer season.



1.5 Confirm reserved tour components

Introduction

Once the risks related to the itinerary have been identified, a risk management plan addressing contingency plans must be developed, ready for implementation if required. All tourism businesses have a duty of care in regards to the safety and security of both customers and staff.

What is duty of care? Duty of care is a legal principle: it is the legal duty to take reasonable care, steps so that others aren't harmed. Failure to fulfil duty of care results in being considered guilty of negligence.

Determining what could go wrong and the consequences involved is a critical step in any tour planning. It is also the first step in risk management.

Risk management

What is a risk?

A risk is the possibility that harm such as death, injury or illness might occur when exposed to a hazard or source of danger. Any risk has the potential to have a negative impact on a tour, however the potential risks associated with a walking city tour are very different from the potential hazards and risks associated with a bush tour.

In order to develop and implement a successful risk management policy, the following four steps must be followed:

- Risk identification
- Risk assessment
- Risk control
- Monitor and review.



Contingency plans

Contingency plans are part of risk control management and will ensure that, if safe to do so, the itinerary can be followed.

Using examples from 1.4, below is a user friendly table detailing both risks and contingency plans.

Risks identified	Risk contingency plan/s
Political instability due to a recent change of government or impending elections	• Avoid capital city/cities • Cancel tour
Tourists being targeted in relation to theft	• Increase tour group members awareness • Have extra security
Trekking	• Disclaimer in place addressing adverse weather conditions
Bushfire risk areas during summer months in Australia	• Check bushfire alert information on a regular basis • Avoid areas deemed as "high risk"

Risks identified	Risk contingency plan/s
Medical assistance	• Have at least a level 3 First Aider with the tour and if possible a Doctor on the team or close by on call
Medium to High risk tour activities such as snorkelling and diving	• Have at fully qualified instructor as a staff member • Ensure proper training takes place prior to activity • For diving activity, ensure that the group tour members have the required qualification and recent practice • Ensure all tour group members have all completed the disclaimer form

1.6 Confirm reserved tour components

Introduction

The last step of the tour itinerary preparation is to confirm all finalised tour components to all concerned suppliers so they have the information they need, with enough detail and notice, to provide the products and services as per the commercial arrangement they have with your organisation.

Information distribution

The confirmation of all tour components to the relevant supplier will include:

- Tour group members details:
 - Name
 - Age
 - Gender
 - Fitness level
 - Special requests
 - Previous history, experience if relevant
- Booking confirmation numbers
- Specific requirements relating to the travel/destinations such as:
 - Visa requirements
 - Health issues
 - Time to arrive prior to departure
 - Customs and immigration requirements
- Relevant payment, advance deposit.



Information confirmation

In turn, as the main organiser, you need to obtain:

- Name and contact details of the key personnel from all external suppliers of products and services involved in the tour delivery from the transport company or companies to the accommodation, restaurants and all other service providers
- Their terms and conditions with your organisation
- Relevant documentation you need from booking confirmation to tickets, vouchers in hard copy or digital form or both.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 1.1 You are required to select 2 different tours available in your region:
 - One short tour and one extended tour (one night or more)
 - You will use those 2 tours for all the work projects relevant to the element just covered: Prepare for tour itinerary
 - Using the information obtained:
 - Identify the requirements for both itineraries.
 - 1.2. Compare the terms and conditions for:
 - Payment terms: from deposit to final payment
 - Options confirmations timeline
 - Use a table format to present your findings.
 - 1.3. Your next step is to compile a list of all suppliers your organisation will be using to deliver the 2 selected tours tour:
 - Compile one list for each tour.
 - 1.4 & 1.5 Using the 2 tours you have selected:
 1. Identify at least 2 potential risks
 2. Develop contingency plans for the identified risks.
 - 1.6 Using the suppliers list from 1.3
 - Document how you will confirm the relevant tour component to the relevant supplier.
-

Summary

Prepare for tour itinerary

- Identify the requirements in the itinerary:
 - Inclusions-Dates and times-Destinations-Activities
 - Carriers
 - Suppliers and providers
 - Booking details
 - Payment
 - Changes
- Clarify requirements relating to the itinerary:
 - Check payments and deposits against policies, terms and conditions
 - Obtain final preferences from customers
 - Follow up on customers having failed to pay, confirm tour
- Plan tour in accordance with briefing information:
 - Advising carriers, suppliers and providers of confirmed information
 - Seek input and information from those carriers, suppliers and providers
 - Source new carriers, suppliers and providers if required
 - Manage all reservations for the tour
 - Manage all tour itinerary details
 - Manage customers' needs and expectations
- Identify tour related risks:
 - Potential external risks such as political instability, adverse weather conditions
 - Potential risks associated with the itinerary such as infrastructure available, access to services and transport
- Develop contingency plans for risks:
 - Develop and implement a risk management policy
 - Develop contingency plans for the identified potential risks
- Confirm reserved tour components:
 - Inform relevant service providers of all required information to effectively provide the required services: names, contact details, bookings confirmation numbers, activities and all specific visa ,customs and immigration requirements, make payment if required
 - Obtain confirmation of all arrangements booked, with terms and conditions, from carriers to accommodation, venues, parks, in both digital and hard copy and update customers files.

Element 2: Conduct departure-related activities

2.1 Greet tour group members

2.4 Provide tour briefing

Greet tour group members

Introduction

First impressions are very important. Every tour should always start with a greeting and a tour briefing.

Greeting tour group members is an important aspect of any tour as a good welcome sets the scene for a good tour.

It increases the chance of the tour group members having a positive experience from the start, enhances their satisfaction and improves the chance of repeat visits and referral business.

Tour introduction: meet and greet

To give tour participants a positive and welcoming first impression, tour leader/guide, tour staff need to:

- Welcome all tour group members in a warm and open manner, with a friendly face and a smile to make everyone feel at ease in order to bring the individuals as a group, setting the mood and the tone of the group and encouraging feelings of goodwill
- Make sure the tour leader/guide must be visible to all at the meeting point
- Introduce himself, herself
- In addition to having introduced yourself, introduce any co-workers who will be part of the tour, this may include:
 - Assistant tour host
 - Vehicle driver
 - Interpreter
 - Guest speaker
- Then, in turn, it is recommended to have tour group members introducing themselves to the group.



Building rapport, employing interpersonal skills

'Rapport' refers to the relationship between tour leaders, guides and the tour group members.

Tour leaders, guides must strive for a rapport which is positive, friendly and understanding. A good rapport is one where all parties share similar feelings and agree about the majority of things.

Tour leaders, guides should start rapport building as soon as they meet a tour group member.

A good rapport is important because it:

- Enhances visitor engagement
- Sets the scene for a better experience
- Helps overcome small problems that crop up
- Encourages repeat and referral business.

Rapport-building techniques using interpersonal skills

Good rapport building costs nothing but does require some effort.

Techniques to build rapport with participants may include:

- Extending/building on conversations when tour guides greeted people
- Asking participants questions
- Using icebreakers
- Using anecdotes when interacting with participants
- Using humour when talking with people
- Checking on people's welfare
- Applying suitable interpersonal and communication skills at every opportunity/exchange.



The tour leader, guide must make it very clear to all tour members that he, she is pleased to see the, happy to be there and encourage questions at any time.

Provide tour briefing

Introduction

The tour briefing follows the introductions. It provides the tour group members with all the information they need to know in regards to the tour and will include.

Tour related information

This deals with talking through and explaining the itinerary in detail and can be done by either going through distributed hand out or, depending where the briefing is taking place, the tour leader, guide might be using a board or visual copy of the hand out such as power point and review information such as:

- Identify the site/s, venue/s, tour area/s
- Explain the type of sightseeing, inclusion the tour group members are taking by:
 - Naming the tour
 - Identify the duration of the tour
- Provide an overview of what the tour will cover detailing inclusions and explain options, if applicable .This may include mention of:
 - Points of interest and highlights
 - Special events which have been organised for the specific group
 - Unique features on this tour
 - Demonstrations and activities
 - Displays and shows
 - Meals and refreshments
 - Free time
 - Photo opportunities
- As much as possible, providing personal anecdotal information and examples to illustrate points
- Be enthusiastic, give a positive and interesting mental picture of the tour to come
- Create a positive experience by being friendly, approachable and inclusive. A good strategy is to Include a Question and Answer session so participants have an opportunity to:
 - Find answers to pressing issues before the tour starts
 - Clarify issues and arrangements
 - Respond to potential concerns.



2.2 Complete outstanding customer details

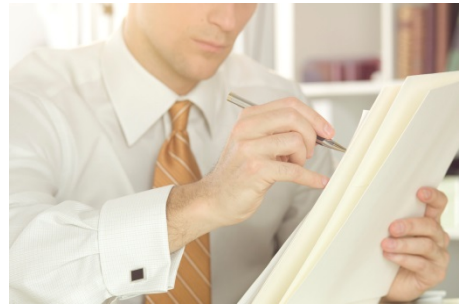
Introduction

While all tour members are present, it is important to complete and finalised all outstanding information.

Outstanding details

Name spelling and pronunciation

We all like to have our name correctly pronounced and written. It is recommended names are checked for pronunciation and spelling during the briefing, and name badges, if required and appropriate, issued after.



Options confirmation

Again, this is the best time to reconfirm options chosen by tour group members in regards to various activities they can choose to as part of a package.

Checking of documentation

Outstanding documentation can be checked and or collected such as:

- All forms related to Occupational Health and Safety such as participation and disclaimer form if appropriate for high risk activities
- Any outstanding payment.

Issuing of documentation to tour group members such as:

- Receipts for received payments
- Tour group members bags and luggage to tour group members who could not be there earlier
- Company welcome bag, venue kit if applicable. The tour leader, guide will go through the bag/s content with the tour group members and explain some of the content if required.

In light of all the above information collected, the customer individual file together with the tour master file will be updated to reflect the additional information and or changes.

2.3 Distribute tour-related information

Introduction

Depending on the type of tour and itinerary, the tour related information to be distributed to tour group members will greatly vary.

Tour related information

Tour related information might be delivered:

- As part of the overall tour briefing
- And/or as separate hard copies hand out or in a digital format and will cover:

Tour rules

- Do and don't behaviour, respect others, be on time for activities
- Communication protocols such as:
 - Feeling free to ask questions throughout the tour
 - Notify tour leader, guide, tour staff if they are feeling uncomfortable or unwell
 - Conflict procedures
 - Tell tour leader, guide should they become injured, distressed or become aware of anything jeopardising the safety of the tour, group
- Specific sites policies that must be adhered to such as photographic restrictions
- Safety precautions
- Advising tour group members about safety precautions can include:
 - Screening a video/DVD
 - Reading a prepared script
 - Distributing safety equipment and/or protective clothing
 - Demonstrating how to use safety equipment
 - Assisting participants with using, wearing their safety items.



General information

- Issuing of maps, leaflets, tourism information
- When overseas, information related to local times, exchange rates and currency exchange locations
- General information and advice on tipping, local customs
- General information on destinations, attractions, sites and activities.

Specific information

- Details of transfer from arrival terminal to accommodation and other venues
- Details of transfer to departure terminal from accommodation and other venue
- Information related to sightseeing tours, trips and activities part of the tour
- Options for free time activities
- Vouchers, coupons such as lunch vouchers, gift coupons. Tour group members need to be reminded to keep those in a safe place
- Copies of all relevant travel documentation required for:
 - Individual tour group member file
 - Tour master file.



2.5 Provide last-minute confirmations, payments and booking details to suppliers, providers and carriers

Introduction

The briefing has been the opportunity to confirm all last minute details, obtain final payment from tour members. The information collated now needs to be passed on to the relevant carrier, supplier, provider of products and services.

Confirmations

Management and tour leaders, guides need to action those last minute confirmations, payment and booking details by:

- Advising the carrier and or supplier, provider of products and services when changes have occurred. For example changes to
- Numbers and/or food/meal requirements: the catering department or hotel, motel, resort must be advised
- Increase in final number of participants for a city tour offered as part of the itinerary: the coach company, if applicable, and all venues part of the tour from museum to botanical garden need to be advised
- Accommodation requirements such as tour group members having requested, at the last minute, interconnecting room for a family and children or rooms next to each other: the accommodation establishment/s must be contacted to check if the request can be accommodated.



There may be a need to:

- Make sure the customer understands that the organisation will always try to accommodate changes to agreed arrangements. However last minute changes might not be possible. For example in regards to requesting interconnecting rooms, the establishment might not have any of those types of rooms left available
- Advise customer, group of additional charges as some alterations to agreed arrangements may necessitate the charging of extra fees or recouping of additional costs
- Record all changes required so there is certainty about what is required, what has been changed.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

2.1 & 2.4 Using the information you have now gathered for your extended tour for element 1: Preparing the tour itinerary:

Prepare your:

1. Meet and greet
 2. Tour briefing including all the required information as covered in the workbook.
- 2.2. Design a check list of all customer details you need to have for the tour you are leading.
- 2.3. Prepare a list of the information you need to distribute to the tour group members & research on the internet:
- Find 2 examples of Rules of Tour from any tour company
 - Which one do you think is better? Why?
- 2.5 Comment on why it is essential to provide last minute confirmations, payments and booking details to products and services suppliers.
-

Summary

Conduct departure-related activities

- Greet tour group members:
 - Meet and greet introduction
 - Build rapport by using interpersonal skills
- Tour briefing:
 - Tour related information: overview of what the tour will cover by identifying all sites, venues,
 - Introduce all staff members involved
 - Create positive experience and build up group expectations
- Complete outstanding customers details:
 - Name spelling and pronunciation
 - Options confirmation
 - Documentation finalisation
 - Issuing of documentation
- Distribute tour related information:
 - Tour rules: do and don'ts-communication procedures-safety precautions
 - General information: maps and leaflet distribution, currency, sites information
 - Specific information related to the tour activities, timing, vouchers distribution
- Provide last minute information:
 - Confirm all necessary parties of any changes in numbers if applicable, if not confirm final numbers, advise of last minute requests, action last minute payments
 - Ensure customers understand last minute requests might not be accommodated
 - Record all changes required.

Element 3: Brief tour staff

3.1 Provide tour details to tour staff

Introduction

Tour staff must be provided with all the required information they will need while on tour. The information ranges from an in depth knowledge of the itinerary with all inclusions and options, to tour risks, the group profile and the relevant documentation.

The tour itinerary is the road map for any tour. The itinerary describes the traveller's route and direction of travel. It lists travel arrangements in the date of order that they are taken, and often lists them day by day. All locations and sites visited by the tour group members are included.

Itinerary

As previously explained an itinerary is a document which lists all of the travel arrangements made for the tour group members.

Managers will need to develop two itineraries:

- One is given to the passengers who come on tour
- The other itinerary, often known as a running sheet, is an internal document the tour leader, guide and includes any additional comments, notes, reminders or tasks that the tour leader, guide has to complete to ensure the smooth operation of the tour.



This itinerary is part of the tour brief. It describes:

- The duration of the tour: dates are included in the itinerary, from the first day of arrangements to the last day
- Transport:
 - Domestic and international flights
 - Transfers and connections
 - Rail and coach journeys, car hire and ferry journeys.

The brief must also contain contact details for all carriers, suppliers, provider and the negotiated conditions for the tour:

- Accommodation
- Meals
- Any packaged tours, inclusions, options: what they are and how to manage them in regards to reconfirming final numbers with customers and suppliers

- Entry to sightseeing, attractions, sites or events such as sporting events, theatre. Any change of circumstances must be specified such as summer time opening hours for a botanical garden resulting in a change of timetable for the day with this inclusion
- In regards to the duty of care for both customers and staff, the various potential risks identified in relation to the itinerary, visits and activities must be covered:
 - Staff must apply comply with OHS requirements and/or accommodate other operational constraints of the site
 - Staff must be made aware of the tour specific risks. The risk for an educational tour visiting mainly landmarks and museums are different from a tour including a diving or sky diving activity
 - Staff must be aware of the organisation emergency management plans
 - They must also be fully trained to apply contingency planning arrangements from simply changing venue if necessary to dealing with the media in the eventuality of a serious emergency
 - Most organisations will have a template they use for itineraries. Below is a link to an Australian website providing a checklist/template you can download and contextualize:
 - <https://www.smallbusiness.wa.gov.au/TourismBoost/pricing-tools-checklists-and-templates/guide-planning-a-tour-itinerary/>.



Group profile

Prior to the start of the tour, tour staff needs to be provided with as much details as possible on the tour group members so they understand the group profile. This in turn will help to understand better the type of customer service expected. Details will include:

- Number of participants
- Type of group
- Origin
- Special needs, requirements
- Special requests
- Age range, socio economic background
- Disabilities
- Language spoken
- Main interests and expectations
- Potential identified problem customers.

Documentation

The tour brief should contain all of the information that the tour guide needs to successfully conduct the tour. Documentation required during the course of the tour includes:

- Rooming lists for:
 - Accommodation
 - Catering
 - Inclusions
 - Optional activities
- Entry permits
- Insurances, authorisations
- The tour staff must also complete:
 - Tour daily log
 - Required reports such as sales reports.

In addition, some documentation, forms need to be forwarded to the host organisation for reference and accounting. They can be:

- Invoices
- Payment receipts including credit cards vouchers and charge forms.

Depending on the host organisation policies, procedures and the tour location and access to technology, the forms might be scanned and the original handed over at the completion of the tour.



3.2 Provide resources to support tour

Introduction

Resources to support the tour must be provided to the staff during the tour brief. Again depending on where the host enterprise is based, where the tour is taking place and the level of technology available, some of the resources might now be in soft copy, or both soft and hard copy.

Documentation

The required documentation ranges from:

- Official mandatory documents such as:
 - Permits granting entry to:
 - national parks
 - museums in some countries such as Saudi Arabia
 - Licenses to operate the business
 - Authorizations in regards to entry to countries, and destination
 - Travel documentation for both tour members and staff such as:
 - Passports
 - Visa, if applicable
- Specific information pertinent to tour group members such as:
 - Medical details:
 - Allergy
 - Medical condition: having a tour group member with a pace maker, or being diabetic
- Vouchers, tickets for all components:
 - Transport
 - Accommodation
 - Sites
- Relevant documentation such as:
 - A detailed the tour itinerary, preferably on a daily basis, listing
 - all the places to be visited
 - accommodation and meals requirements
 - A detailed schedule in regards to the tour itinerary, preferably on a daily basis, clearly specifying:
 - What time various activities
 - How long they are scheduled for



- Maps of the venues, sites, parks to be visited: those can now be hard or digital copies so the tour staff can familiarize themselves with the site, in advance, specially the first time they deliver the tour and itinerary
- List of industry contacts involved in the tour:
 - Name of organisations in country and region that are involved in the tour itinerary. These organisations will cover all services offered during the tour and include:
 - Carriers
 - Accommodation
 - Catering
 - Sites
 - Activities
 - Name of the staff member listed as the designated contact and name of staff member, if different, designated to be contactable in case of emergency
 - Contact details: email, land line, mobile, Skype number if available
- Company policy manual guideline, hard or soft copy
- Letter of authority, cash and credit cards for staff to conduct business if any change requires additional negotiation and additional payment
- Vehicles and supplies as required for an extended tour. For example an extended bush camping tour will require:
 - Four wheel drive:
 - Staff member able and experience to drive the vehicle
 - Check list confirming the vehicle is in good working conditions for the tour
 - Supplies:
 - Water
 - Food
 - First Aid kit
- Special requests made by tour members: can they be accommodated? Typical examples would be:
 - Diet, specific meal
 - Room location
 - Flight seat request
 - Special needs for disabled tour group members.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

3.1 & 3.2 You are required to prepare a brief for the tour staff of one of the tours you selected at the beginning of the unit. You need to:

- Go through the itinerary you are providing the tour staff with
- Clarify the group profile
- List which relevant resources you are providing to support the tour such as official documents and all tour related documents and information.

Summary

Brief tour staff

- Provide tour details to tour staff includes:
 - Up to date tour itinerary with all the relevant details
 - Group profile with as much details as possible on the customers
 - All the relevant documentation require for the smooth delivery of the tour from rooming list to detailed list of inclusions and optional activities
 - Identification of all the documentation needing to be captured while on tour such as receipts, invoices
- Provide resources to support tour:
 - Official documents such as permits, licences, travel documentation
 - Vouchers, tickets for transportation, accommodation, entry to venues
 - List of industry contacts and organisations supplying services during the tour
 - Letter of authority, cash and credit card to conduct business if required.

Element 4:

Liaise with external industry colleagues throughout the tour

4.1 Liaise with industry personnel to facilitate tour implementation

Introduction



A successful tour implementation rests on accurate and timely information dissemination and management. All concerned parties need to action bookings, requests, changes and confirm them in the shortest time possible, hence the importance of liaising with external industry colleagues throughout the tour.

External industry colleagues include all external suppliers involved during the tour, ranging from carriers to handling agents on the ground, catering company, guest speakers, and staff of the various venues part of the itinerary.

During the tour, the group leaders and guides priority is to 'lead' the tour. They need to be supported and some aspects of managing the tour itinerary might be carried out by support office staff from the host organisation.

Liaising with industry personnel to facilitate tour implementation

Team work is crucial to the success of a tour and the 'behind the scene' work essential. Industry personnel might be contacted in regards to:

Enquiries: the tour group leader of a standard tour has found out that some tour group members have a specific interest in history in addition to the sightseeing and simply visiting and taking pictures. He, she will contact the office staff and or handling agent so they can gather historical information, facts and figures, pass them on that so, in turn, he, she can share the gathered information with the interested tour group members.

Confirmations, requests: forward confirmations are required to advise all service providers involved and make sure the tour will be delivered as per the itinerary. The information will cover:

- Dates and times and duration for:
 - Transport
 - Accommodation and catering requirements
 - Inclusions: visits, guests speakers, activities

- Final numbers of tour group members for:
 - Transport
 - Accommodation and catering
 - Inclusions: visits, guest speakers, activities
- Any change in time, number of participants must be flagged and negotiated with the providers. Every staff member of the host organisation must know who to communicate with contact for each different request from transport to optional activity. This information should be provided in the form of data base available both hard and digital copy at all times and for all to use
- Once the request has been communicated, confirmation of the amendment/s need to be confirmed
- The next step is to notify the tour guides/leaders. It is imperative that all information and documentation forwarded is clear, accurate, easy to understand, action and/or follow for all parties concerned
- All changes must be recorded for future reference following the organisations requirements.



Forward bookings:

Forward bookings are different from forward confirmations. They involve contacting all sites and venues featuring on the itinerary as optional.

For example contacting the museum on the itinerary to:

- Confirm that the visit is taking place as enough tour group members having chosen the visit as an option
- Confirming how many participants will be there and at what time so that the specialist staff scheduled to provide a guided tour and commentary is available and ready.

4.2 Request assistance, where appropriate

Introduction

There might be time when assistance will be required from external industry colleagues. This will mostly take place when very specialised advice is required due to a set of circumstances that has happened during the tour.

Assistance request

Standard specialised advice usually deals with specific rules, regulations, and where the host organisation does not have a staff member with expertise in the required area.

Seeking advice, recommendations and suggestions

After the beginning of the tour, your company has been advised that a sudden change of regulation in the country where the tour is now requires special permit to enter a national park included on the itinerary. The permit must be presented prior to the group tour members enter the park:

- You will need to get in touch with your contact on the ground, your handling agent overseas, if applicable, to organise the permit by:
 - Filling in all the required forms and paperwork
 - Submitting them to the relevant authority
 - Ensuring ,as much as you can, that the process is going to be quick enough for the permit to be issued and forwarded to the tour guides/leaders so the visit can take place
- You might also need to seek legal advice, in regards to your liability, should the permit not be delivered in time for the group tour members to access the park and the activity
- Recommendation and suggestion from the local contact will help your organisation make an informed decision which alternative to offer to the tour group members.



Negotiating changes to requirements

Building on this example, should you need to organise an alternative option for the tour whether it is a visit to another park or a different type of activity, you need to consider the group profile and interest to minimise disruption and disappointment. The negotiation will take place at various levels:

- With the authorities, if applicable: you might be able to negotiate a fast tracking of the paperwork or even an exemption on the ground of the short notice
- The different suppliers of products and services affected by the situation need to be contacted:
 - If the permit is not issued in time and an alternative venue such as another park in the same region is chosen, the implications may be:
 - Change of time for the visit depending on the location. The travel time required to get to the park might be longer or shorter. This in turn will impact on the departure time for the activity

- Change of time due to a 'flow on effect' for other visits, meals and even accommodation departure and/or arrival time
- It is paramount to ensure all parties concerned are advised with as much notice as possible to get organised and deliver the required products and services
- As previously mentioned, every change must be documented and costed as per the organisational procedures.

4.3 Make on tour agreements with organisations to respond to issues arising

Introduction

Unexpected events which are unavoidable and out of your control might happen. New plans, agreements might have to be organised as part of the on tour management . In order to manage unexpected events, it is important to differentiate issues and emergencies:

Issues: an issue will cause disruption to the tour but will not jeopardise the whole tour.

- The type of issues that may arise during a tour are numerous and could include such things as:
 - Illness such as:
 - Allergic reaction such as asthma or hay fever
 - Sunstroke

If a customer falls ill during a tour, you have to keep the best interests of the following people in mind: the sick customer, the other tour group members and your colleagues.

- Theft
- An unexpected phone call to a tour group member having to leave the tour for personal reasons such as family member emergency
- The venue reserved has been double booked and is being used for another purpose and not available for your tour
- Coach breakdown
- Airline strike
- Road closure
- Traffic accident
- Weather conditions.

Emergencies:

There are also many types of emergencies that may arise during a tour, and an emergency might result in a significant disruption or even the cancellation of the tour. This topic will be covered separately in element 6.



On tour agreements

To solve arising issues arising while on tour existing contractual agreements may have to be re-negotiated or a new agreement might have to be established with the existing suppliers of products and services.

Contractual arrangements:

Depending on the issue, existing contractual arrangements might have to be renegotiated or new arrangements might have to be established together with payments terms and conditions:

- For example, one of the highlight of the tour is the visit of a sacred site and only 15 people are allowed per day. Due to a very last minute change: on customer booked has fallen sick and has been replaced by a couple that was on the waitlist, you have now 16 people, the guide/leader or an office representative needs to contact the venue to negotiate the extra person entry
- Another issue could be the breakdown of the coach you have booked for a whole day winery tour and the company you work with is unable to provide you with another coach. They have arranged another company to provide you with a coach, however you will have to:
 - Get in touch with the new carrier to confirm all arrangement such as coach capacity, arrival, departure times and places, how long it is needed for: half a day, a day
 - Depending on the organisational structure, organise payment or liaise with head office so that payment is authorized and actioned
- Another example would be that upon your arrival at the airport to take a domestic flight for another leg of the tour, you find the flight is delayed by a couple of hours. To make sure the situation is handled in the best interest of the tour group members, the following actions need to take place:
 - Advise tour group members of situation
 - Contact airline ground staff to get an update of the situation
 - Ask if your group can have complementary food and beverage vouchers and or
 - Ask if they can use a passengers lounge, if available
- Make sure all tour group members stay together for regular updates.



New arrangements

- Continuing with the flight delay, the flow on effect will require the following new arrangements:
 - Advising the relevant carriers: coach, cruise liner that all tour group members are delayed and have a later arrival time
 - The same protocol applies to accommodation venues and restaurants and other venues such as sites, museums, art galleries part of the itinerary that will be impacted by a late arrival
 - Ongoing communication need to take place until the final arrival time is confirmed by the airline
- Another issue could be that the tour leader/guide has been taken ill while conducting a tour overseas. As time is of the essence, your best option would be to contact your handling agent on the ground to find a replacement staff already in country able to fill in at very short notice.



Responding to emergency events

This topic will be covered under element 6.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

4.1 Referring to your selected extended tour:

- List the external industry colleagues you will liaise and work with to provide the tour products and service to the tour group members.

4.2. Clearly explain when, as a tour leader, you might have to request assistance from external industry colleagues. You can use an example relevant to one of the 2 tours you are working on.

4.3. You have just loaded the tour group on to a vehicle for an overnight country tour and a tour group member has just received a phone call: a family member is ill and he needs to go back home as soon as possible. You are able to organise a site vehicle from your company to take him back to the city so he can go to the hospital:

- What other actions must you take in regards to the customer having left your tour?

Summary

Liaise with external industry colleagues throughout the tour

- Liaise with industry personnel to facilitate tour implementation in regards to:
 - Enquiries
 - Bookings
 - Confirmations
 - Changes and special requests
- Request assistance, where appropriate for:
 - Seeking information, advice, recommendations and suggestions
 - Negotiating changes to requirements
- Make on tour agreements with organisations to respond to issues arising:
 - Re-negotiating existing contractual arrangements
 - Establishing new contractual arrangements
 - If required: organise transport and book optional activities
 - Arrange to use staff from a third party
 - Organise required payment.

Element 5:

Manage on tour itinerary

5.1 Facilitate conduct of the tour schedule

Introduction

Team work and management support are essential to facilitate the tour conduct and ensure the tour runs on schedule. This is important not only for the group tour members but also for all the service providers from transport, to accommodation and venue, to ensure they are clear on when their services are required.

Office based assistance

Providing office based assistance to tour group leaders/guides will enable the staff on the ground to concentrate on the daily tasks, events and customer service. The assistance might cover:

Tour itinerary management

- Liaison with all suppliers to confirm they can deliver the products, service they have been contracted for in an efficient and timely manner. The dialogue must be positive and within the parameters of the contractual agreement. The latest information needs to cover:
 - Number of passengers, tour group members
 - Arrival and departure time for all concerned:
 - Transport
 - Accommodation
 - Catering
 - Venues, attractions, special activities booked
 to ensure that, as much as possible, that the tour schedule can be adhered to.
 - Confirming the delivery of all inclusions
 - At all times the group tour members enjoyment of the tour must be kept in mind and if any complaints arise they must be manage quickly and efficiently.



Communication and information management

In numerous instances, the office based staff members will be communicating on behalf of the tour group leaders/guides. Communication covers all areas of the tour and to support the delivery of the itinerary, the office staff members may as just mentioned:

- Liaise with all service suppliers to promote a positive relationship, optimum service and customer satisfaction It is recommended to:
 - Check that the supplier deliver the product, service within the parameters of the contract in terms of:
 - Standard, quality of products and services
 - Delivery time of products and service
 - Foster the relationship by personal visit to meet staff face to face and discuss any issues, problems
 - Making payments as required for products and services to be delivered in a timely manner
 - Complaints, problems whether they are from the group tour members or the carriers, providers need to be investigated. Each enterprise, organisation should have dispute resolution process covering:
 - Problem
 - Outcome desired
 - How to achieve the outcome
- The tour group leaders/guides need to given provided with a data base of information containing:
 - Destination information such as:
 - Contact names and numbers of every service supplier: transport, accommodation, catering, venues and activities, handling agent if applicable
 - Emergency contact names and numbers in case of an emergency for each supplier
 - Contact names and number for local authorities such as:
 - Hospital
 - Police
 - Fire brigade
 - Local, in country agencies and representatives such as handling agent if applicable, tourist information centre, if available
 - Embassy or consulate if applicable.



5.2 Advise tour staff regarding issues arising

Introduction

In some circumstances, the host enterprise might be aware or be made aware of issues arising before the tour staff. Nowadays, this will take place mainly when the tour is located in an area where mobile and internet communication is poor or non-existent together with a lack of access to media such as TV news.

Communication strategies

Advice in regards to

It can cover information update due to specific research or potential hazards:

- Generic information:
 - Potential hazard such as forecasted adverse weather conditions that will impact on the tour itinerary and the tour staff will need to action the organisation wet weather plan
- Specific issue such as an accommodation venue, in an isolated part of the country, has contacted the office staff to advise that due a double booking situation, it is not able to accommodate your tour. It has provided a couple of alternative accommodation suggestions that could house the tour
- Keep the communication channel opened and inform the tour staff of updates.

Action taken

- Wet weather plan needs to be actioned by the tour staff
- The office staff needs to book the best alternative accommodation venue.

Briefing information

The tour group members' interest and security must be take precedent over any other consideration, such as financial consideration.

The briefing information, when passed on to the tour staff, must be very clear, including all relevant details and the tour leader, guide will, in turn, convey this information onto the group tour members.



5.3 Re-plan itinerary as required

Introduction

Some issues will require to re plan the itinerary. However a change in the itinerary should take place when all other avenues to resolve the issue have been explored due to the impact it will have on group tour members and staff alike. The re-planning of the itinerary will require coordination between all concerned parties: from the tour staff on the ground to the office staff, management and all products and services suppliers. The main focus should be to consider the best interest of the tour group members to ensure as little disruption as possible.

Management of issues

Team work together with following the organisations guidelines is pivotal to manage a change of itinerary and its various aspects and consequences.

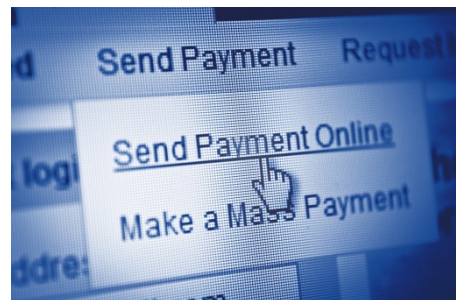
Issue response: different issues warrant different responses.

Let's look at 2 different issues: road closure and wet weather condition.

Road closure

Action:

- Situation: the only road leading to the accommodation booked for your tour tonight: a landmark castle turned into a hotel is closed due to a land slide. An alternative accommodation venue needs to be found and booked considering the following:
 - Location
 - Standard
 - Size
 - Arrival and departure time
 - Catering requirements if applicable
 - Availability for both accommodation and catering requirements
 - Payment.



Wet weather

- Situation: due to ongoing torrential rain, the visit of an outdoor animal sanctuary cannot take place. Your organisation should have a wet weather plan and an adequate venue lined up such as:
 - A visit to a nearby museum:
 - Contact must be made with the museum to check the possibility of the organising this last minute visit
 - Negotiate time and duration, venue guide if applicable
 - Organise payment

- Organising a guest speaker to deliver a talk about the outdoor animal sanctuary by:
 - Contacting industry colleagues, your own network you might have used before
 - Organise time, place and length of talk
 - Organise payment if applicable
- The very last option is to simply cancel the visit and guide group tour member free time, however liabilities need to be carefully examined.

Legislation and liabilities:

Itinerary changes might have financial impact on the costing of the tour and care must be taken to ensure that:

- The host enterprise, organisation is compliant with the relevant:
 - Policies and procedures in relation to fair trading of the host country where the tour is taking place
 - In line with the relevant codes of practice in regards to the issue
 - In line with the company's terms and conditions for the issue
- The host enterprise, organisation determines the cost associated to the change and its consequence, flow on effect to the tour overall cost and bottom line
- Decision must be made to pass on potential extra charges to the tour group members due to the revised arrangements. Organisations should exercise care when making this decision as it can impact on their reputation.

Confirmation and communication

All alternative arrangements need to be confirmed by:

- Obtaining an official detailed confirmation written or digital form from the suppliers of products, services in regards to the revised requirements
- As part of the ongoing communication process, notify tour group leaders, guides of the confirmation of the revised arrangements and bookings
- Prepare and forward hard copy or digital copy of the revised itinerary to all concerned suppliers, parties.



Customer service

Minimising disruption to tour group members is paramount to ensure good customer service, customers satisfaction and, in the long run, the organisation's reputation.

- Advise the tour group members immediately, in a sensitive manner, of changes the issue, event has caused to the itinerary
- Explain the new schedule and itinerary
- Be positive and sell the new arrangements to the group
- Apologize for the issue if required
- Thank them for their understanding.

At all times, the organisation and tour staff need to ensure tour group needs are still met to the best extent possible.

5.4 Maintain contact with those responsible for resolving on tour issues

Introduction

Contact must be maintained at all times with all parties responsible to resolve the on tour issues identified. This needs to take place until the issue is resolved, and the delivery of replacement products, services has been successfully negotiated, communicated and delivered with the best outcome for all concerned.

How to maintain contact

The steps will vary depending on the issue and the tour size, location and may involve:

Central contact point

- A contact staff member needs to be nominated to act as a central point for all communication to make sure the information from all parties:
 - Products and service suppliers
 - Tour staff
 - Organisation's head office is collected, collated and disseminated as required. This would be essential if the tour is in an isolated, 'out of range' area and contacting the staff is problematic
- Depending on the location of the tour, language might be an issue to deal with the issue with relevant authority, services suppliers whether it is for transport, accommodation, catering, and venues. It is recommended to make sure the staff dealing with the issue is fluent in the language. If not a third party might have to be employed on a short term basis.



Progress report

Maintaining contact also involves:

- Organisation head office and tour staff need to regularly check on progress of the issue resolution to:
 - Know which stage the issue resolution is at
 - Inform the tour group members
- Providing supplementary information as required
- In light of this supplementary information, engaging in negotiations.

The following example scenario illustrates the points just covered:

- On the way to an evening cultural show featuring local dancers, the mini bus taking the tour group members breaks down:
 - Urgent alternative transport is required
 - The tour leader will contact head office to organise a replacement minibus
 - While head office is making call to organise the replacement minibus, regular contact must be maintained so the tour leader is kept informed on the progress of the search
 - Head office informs the tour leader that there is no mini bus available in the area and the next option is to organise taxis to take the tour group members to the show
 - The tour leader might be required to confirm how many tour members required transport and how far they are, at the present time, from the show location
 - The head office will liaise to confirm what time the taxis will be arriving
 - Another action to take might be to ring the show organiser and advice that:
 - Your party will be delayed
 - If the show is opened to the public, not only to your organisation, investigate the possibility of attending the next show if there are a couple of sessions per night
- For any situation it is critical that all parties concerned understand the urgency of the situation such as finding alternative transport or accommodation at short notice when timing is crucial to resolving the issue.

Financial settlement

Negotiations might have to take place if extra payments are required and depending on:

- Who the supplier of products and services is:
 - Existing supplier with an existing contractual agreement with the organisation
 - New supplier: a short term contract will need to be negotiated and implemented
- The agreed terms of payment such as payment stages:
 - Deposit
 - Initial payment
 - Progress payment
 - Final payment.



Using the previous examples, if taxis are used, in most cases, payment will have to be made when the service is supplied.

5.5 Advise industry colleagues regarding tour changes

Introduction

Different issues will have different consequences and impact on the tour itself. Changes can range from a simple delay to the cancellation of an activity, the shortening of the tour or even its cancellation and all industry colleagues need to be advised when the changes affect them.

Industry colleagues liaison

Itinerary changes: as previously covered, any tour alteration can have a flow on effect for the tour itinerary.

The best way to illustrate this is by an example:

While conducting a day tour in the country, your coach has broken down.

You have already made arrangement and assistance is on the way. However it could take up to an hour.

Your group has:

- A lunch booking at a restaurant in 30 minutes, you are about 15 minutes away from the lunch venue by coach. The time schedule for lunch is one hour
- A visit to the local Chocolate factory booked for 2pm.

The industry colleagues you need to liaise with are:

- The restaurant to advise of the delay in your arrival. Between the one hour wait and 15 minutes distance to cover, you envisage the tour group arrival for around 1.45pm
- In turn, the visit to the Chocolate factory will not start at 2pm.

You need to advise both venues and check the time changes can be accommodated. Depending on how busy those two venues are, you might have to alter length of time for either the lunch and visit or even both. For example, if the restaurant can accommodate your group but only for half an hour, this in turn would mean the factory visit could take place earlier. Flexibility is the key in such a situation.

Confirmation of numbers

If the issue relates for example to a tour member illness or health issue such as flu and not being able to join the tour for a specific activity or maybe full day, all affected industry colleagues must be contacted with the final tour group members:

- The museum so the establishment knows how many visitors to expect
- The restaurant so that the meals are prepared in accordance to the number of guests.



5.6 Maintain regular contact with tour group

Introduction

Building on from maintaining contact with those responsible for resolving on tour issues and advising industry colleagues of any changes following the issues, contact with the tour group needs to be established and maintained so that both staff and tour group members are kept informed during the various stages of the issue and its resolution.

Contact protocols

To maintain regular contact, it is essential to:

- Establish the most efficient contact method taking into account the tour location:
 - Phone
 - Internet
 - Message left at a specific spot:
 - Post Office
 - Main store acting as the local Post Office
 - Park ranger
 - Official authorities such as with the Police
- Make sure the tour staff have the latest:
 - Contact names, preferred contact number of all products and service suppliers
- Establish a regular contact schedule to ‘touch base’ taking into account any time, even date difference.



For example if your organisation is based in Asia and the tour you need to be in contact with is in Europe, the time difference could be up to 7 hours taking into account which country you are in, and if the season is winter or summer, as some countries move on to “daylight saving” time in summer.

5.7 Monitor the tour area

Introduction

Another step to manage on tour itinerary requires a constant monitoring of all countries, regions, and areas the tour is scheduled to be at some point in time. Both the organisation and the tour staff need to monitor the area and exercise their duty of care in keeping the group tour members safe.

Monitoring

The aim is to actively monitor the tour area, actively meaning exercise constant vigilance in regards to any potential problems such as:

- Weather conditions:
 - Worsening of weather condition involving:
 - Torrential rain
 - Typhoons, cyclones or other extreme weather
 - Bushfires in Australia
- Transport strike
- Security risk:
 - Bomb threat
 - Terrorist threat
- Health risk:
- Pandemic threat, such as:
 - Swine flu
 - Ebola.



This can be successfully achieved by a range of measures:

- Liaising with the relevant authorities
- Keeping an eye on the weather forecast
- Liaising with all industry colleagues and networks.

In addition the organisation's staff on the ground and the tour staff need to work together as a team and establish as much as possible, ongoing contact. Which team gets the latest information, the one in the office or the one on the ground will depend on the tour location, access to information and networks.

This leads to how to deal with unexpected events.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

5.1 - 5.2 & 5.4 - 5.7

With the support of your trainer, organise a visit to a tour organisation. Prepare a list of questions to establish how they:

- Facilitate conduct of the tour schedule by providing office based assistance office
- What procedures are in place to advise tour staff, on the ground, of issues arising
- How contact is maintained with those responsible for resolving on tour issues, from office staff to official bodies and suppliers or products and services
- What procedures are in place to advise industry colleagues regarding tour changes
- How regular contact is maintained with the tour group
- How the tour area is constantly monitored.

5.3. Design a user friendly check list for re-planning an itinerary.

Summary

Manage on tour itinerary

Facilitate conduct of the tour schedule by:

- Providing office based assistance covering:
 - Tour itinerary management to optimize:
 - Inclusions of all features
 - Adherence to schedules
 - Tour group members tour enjoyment
 - Complaints resolution
- Communication and information management such as:
 - Acting on behalf of tour group leaders/guides
 - Supplying all requested information to assist in case of an issue or emergency
 - Make payments if required.

Advise tour staff regarding issues arising by:

- Passing on information that might be:
 - Resulting specific research such as an information update
 - Potential hazards
- Advising staff of action taken such as bookings made
- Providing briefing information that the tour leaders, guides can pass on to group tour members.

Re-plan itinerary as required by:

- Managing the situation and taking appropriate action such as:
 - Re booking services and products
 - Ensure inclusions can be accommodated as much as possible
 - Prepare revised itinerary copies
- Consider financial and legal aspect by:
 - Determine costs associated with required changes
 - Investigate legislation and liabilities involved
 - Determine if tour group members can be charged for revised requirements
 - Determine if gratuities and/or other options can be offered as compensation
- Minimise disruption to tour group members and apologise if required and appropriate.

Maintain contact with those responsible for resolving on tour issues:

- Organise a central contact point
- Provide ongoing progress report with all parties concerned
- Organise financial settlement for services rendered.

Advise industry colleagues regarding tour changes:

- Notify colleagues affected by the tour changes such as:

- Other carriers
- Accommodation
- Catering
- Venues
- Sites and attractions

of any changes, delays, cancellation.

Maintain regular contact with tour group by:

- Identifying a most efficient method of contact
- Providing all names, numbers, special requirements
- Identify best time to communicate taking time zones into account.

Monitor the tour area:

- Actively monitor the countries, regions, destinations scheduled on the itinerary to identify potential problems and risks
- Maintain contact with industry colleagues.

Element 6:

Deal with unexpected events

6.1 Initiate contingency planning actions

Introduction

When accidents and/or emergencies happen on tour the tour leader, guide and the tour staff, if applicable, are expected to respond in an appropriate manner.

This section examines how to deal with unexpected events. Unexpected events can impact on the tour delivery and must be managed to minimise disruption.

They can include:

- Traffic accident
- Airline strike
- Venue booked suddenly unavailable due to a fire
- Medical emergency
- Natural disaster.

Adequate response is required to effectively:

- Safeguard the tour group members
- Discharge legally imposed obligations
- Meet customer expectations
- Maintain the image, reputation of the business.

However, the tour leader, guide may be unable to assist as required because:

- The matter, issue could be too serious and/or beyond their scope of authority to deal with
- The guide may be incapacitated.

In this instance, the organisation office based team needs to take over and initiate the contingency planning action expected to address the situation.

The appropriate contingency plan initiation needs to be activated by the tour leader/guide or in collaboration with the organisation nominated emergency management team.

To be effective contingency planning actions need to follow a specific sequence.

Step 1:

- Identify the most appropriate contingency plan to implement by referring to the Emergency Management Plan and Standard procedures in place for responding to nominated emergencies.



Step 2:

- Check that the contingency plan is applicable
 - If the contingency plan is applicable: proceed
 - If not develop an emergency specific response plan for emergency.

**Step 3:**

- If required and possible organise external third party support to assist in a specialist capacity.

Step 4:

- 'Make it happen' by, proceed by
 - Giving authorisation when required
 - Providing payment is required. For example providing short-term cash (or purchasing capability) where cash has been lost.

A simple example would be a sick tour group member:

- After calling a doctor, the tour group member has been admitted to the local hospital with a suspected case of severe flu
- Having taken care of the customer and exercised your duty of care, the next step is to:
 - Take care of the other tour group members to make sure they are not inconvenienced or penalised as a result of one sick person. you can achieve this by:
 - As reasonably practical, make sure nothing is left out of the itinerary despite a late start of the tour. Times at places might need to be shorter with shorter breaks and quicker refreshments stops.

6.2 Support tour group leaders/guides

Introduction

While dealing with unexpected events, management support and team work are again essential to ensure the best outcome for all concerned staff and group tour members.

Tour group leaders/guides support

The tour leader/guide is the organisation representative and the staff member on the ground dealing with the situation. The support can be provided in various ways and will depend on the type of event being dealt with and can include.

Provide suggestions and dialogue

In addition, the nature of the support provided can also depend on the tour, travel type and can include:

- Suggest the contingency planning actions most appropriate to the situation explaining:
 - Reason for choice
 - Applying a two ways communication strategy as the group leaders/guides might:
 - Agree with the proposed course of actions
 - Have suggestions or concerns.



On the ground support

- Decision might be taken to send:
 - A Crisis Management Team to the country, destination. This team may just be two people. The larger the number of travellers you have in the destination country, the bigger the team is likely to be. The Crisis Management Team may be sent from Head Office, or may be agency-based.
 - A designated business representative to the location. Instead of sending a team, one person is sent but this person will have:
 - Scope of authority to take whatever action is needed
 - Authority to act on behalf of the company such as:
 - Signing rights to negotiate additional services with a supplier
 - Increase in spending limit to settle additional expenses
 - Resources required to take appropriate, necessary action

Providing 'concrete' on the ground support will help and ease the tour staff workload and provide moral support as this demonstrates the staff on the ground there are not been left to deal with the emergency on their own.

- Requesting and using local 'in country' agencies, services providers if available to assist with:
 - Local customs
 - Customs and Immigration
 - Language and communication

- Providing necessary resources:
 - Human resources as just covered
 - Taking care of replacement clothing and personal items where they have been lost
- Dealing with emergency services such as:
 - Police
 - Ambulance
 - Fire brigade if applicable.



On the ground immediate response is crucial in an emergency situation and tour leaders, guides might need to be given additional level of authority to organise services to minimise the tour group members' inconvenience.

6.3 Research and suggest additional action to be taken

Introduction

In the meantime, additional research and action might be appropriate to deal with the situation that has arisen.

Research and additional action

Depending on the situation, research into a similar situation that already occurred and how it was dealt with will be beneficial and can be achieved by:

Desk top research

Checking dedicated websites for more information on the support provided by some businesses to their travellers who encounter an emergency such as the following one:

http://www.carlsonwagonlit.com/en/global/emergency_assistance

might help to make sure your organisation actions into dealing with unexpected events is in line with other industry suppliers of the same service and having had to face the same situation.

On the ground, experienced authorities and staff members, products and service providers and industry bodies

In addition to dealing with local emergency authorities if required, organising in-country assistance can be provided by using when appropriate:

- Government agencies such as embassy
- Local, regional authorities
- Local government
- Local agencies
- Local industry associations
- Existing local contacts
- Tour group leaders/guides associations
- Any other relevant parties
- Using local contacts, network and associations. identify and contact staff members that have been through a similar experience in similar circumstances as they will have a better understanding of how to best deal with unexpected events based on:
 - Type of event from theft to medical problem
 - Best course of action to take in relation to the location of the tour
 - Best course of action in relation to dealing with tour group members to minimize the inconvenience.



Analysing options taking into account

Once as much information as possible been gathered in regards to most appropriate action to be taken, options need to be considered, and the best one selected. When choosing options, using a customer focused approach should take priority over considering strictly financial considerations.

6.4 Make arrangements in response to identified emergencies

Introduction

Support during an emergency

All emergency situations require action and the action will depend on the type of emergency, its scope and how many people are involved.

New arrangements

Confirming circumstances

Prior to making any changes to the tour, head office and the tour staff on the ground need to confirm that the identified emergency situation is still current. An example would be a cyclone alert for the area a tour, already started, is scheduled to go to within the next 24 hours. In light of an update confirming the change of the cyclone route, the relevant authorities have lifted the alert and the tour can take place as scheduled.

Tour changes

They will include:

- Bookings changes: using the previous example of a cyclone alert, the organisation should have a backup plan; plan B to put into action. The most likely scenario would be to organise another safe location for the tour to go outside of the danger zone. This will require booking transport, accommodation and visits to the new location at short notice and will result in
- Itinerary changes as covered under 5.3
- Financial considerations: the new set of circumstances will involve making payments for the new arrangements in accordance with the new arrangements and your organisation procedures.



Tour cancellation

An organisation will cancel a tour only if it is established it is the safest and only course of action to take – for example in cases where serious conflict, terrorist action or natural disasters happen. Cancelling the tour will involve:

- Organising the tour group repatriation in the shortest time possible, using the safest methods of transport available at the time
- Liaising, as much as possible, with the suppliers of products and services to confirm the tour cancellation.

Communication with families

This will involve liaising with family members of those on tour in order to provide information, updates and reassurances.

The communication need to be conducted:

- On a regular basis
- With sensitivity and dignity
- In the family's language.

The communication channels also need to be suitable to reach the families and might include face to face, Skype, phone.



6.5 Handle media interest

Introduction

In some instances the media may become involved or will be notified due to the nature of the event or emergency.

Media interest

Any dealing with the media should be carefully monitored to ensure the information disseminated is accurate and will not be detrimental to the organisation. Nowadays, it is important to consider all different forms of media: conventional and social/digital, such as Facebook and Twitter.

Media protocol

To effectively manage their public relations, each organisation should have a defined policy or protocol in place in regards to liaising with the media in case of emergency, or events out of the ordinary. It should involve the following:

- Nominate one individual who will be responsible for handling all media. In large sized organisations, it will be a public relations manager; in smaller organisation, the manager. It is important all staff direct all media matters to this designated person from head office
- Prompt communication is crucial in case of an emergency to ensure correct information is divulged and circulated; this includes ensuring truth, accuracy and full situation disclosure.
- To this effect, media release/s must be developed as soon as possible, followed by conducting interviews, and answering question in regards to:
 - The situation
 - The steps the organisation has taken or is taking to best deal with the problem or the emergency
- Maintain ongoing communication with the media via:
 - Organisation's website
 - Organisation's Facebook site and Twitter if available and appropriate
 - Mainstream media such as TV, radio and newspapers if appropriate.

6.6 Amend tour itinerary as required

Please refer to 5.3

Re-plan itinerary as required

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 6.1 - 6.4 You have been asked by the tour operator you work for to design a user friendly check list for tour group leaders to use when dealing with unexpected medical emergencies. You need to include:
- Steps to follow to initiate the appropriate contingency planning actions
 - Steps to follow to support tour group leaders/guides
 - How to research and suggest additional action to be taken
 - Steps to follow to make on the ground arrangements.
- 6.5 On the internet find 2 examples illustrating how some tour companies handle media interest when unexpected events occur during one of their tours. Explain, in your opinion, which one is the better one, why?
- 6.6 Refer to work project 5.3.
-

Summary

Deal with unexpected events

Initiate contingency planning actions:

- Identify contingency plans to be implemented
- Check if the contingency plans are applicable to the actual situation
- Suggest modifications to contingency plans if appropriate
- Arrange for relevant external third party support
- Authorise necessary actions.

Support tour group leaders/guides:

- Provide suggestion and dialogue
- Provide on the ground support: staff, resources
- Liaise with emergency services and government agencies
- Extend line of authority and credit as required.

Research and suggest additional action to be taken by:

- Conducting desk top research
- Contacting:
 - On the ground authorities
 - Experienced staff
 - Service provider
 - Industry bodies
- Analysing options using a customer focused approach
- Seeking updates from all parties, stakeholders.

Make arrangements in response to identified emergencies such as:

- Tour changes
- Tour cancellation and tour group members repatriation
- Communication with tour group members families.

Handle media interest:

- Apply organisation's protocol:
 - Nominate one person as the organisation spokesperson
 - Ensure prompt communication with media
 - Develop media release and conduct media interviews and make statements.

Amend tour itinerary as required: refer to Element 5.3

Element 7:

Finalise tour

7.1 Solicit feedback from tour group members

Introduction

All tours will be required to comply with specific organisational procedures at the end of the tour or shortly after the completion of the tour.

A range of operational and evaluation processes needs to take place to finalise the tour and are as follows:

Obtain feedback from tour group members

It is useful to obtain feedback from tour group members at the conclusion of the tour. Feedback will enable managers to identify what is working and what is not working, what tour guides are doing, what customers want, how to meet their needs.

Feedback can be obtained in various ways:

- Verbal: verbal feedback is general informal. Talking to tour group members at the end of the tour is something every tour staff member should be encouraged to do as it demonstrates interest in the customer point of view. To gain useful feedback, tour guides must:
 - Ask open questions and actively seek opinions and thoughts on the products and services offered during the tour such as: 'For future reference, is there anything else we can do to provide a better experience for you?'
 - Actively listen and identify key points made and issues raised
 - Ask follow up questions to clarify initial points, gain additional information if required
 - Always use politeness, respectful language and show genuine interest



- Written using:
 - Customer comments cards that can be:
 - Handed out to all tour group members who should be encouraged to complete
 - Prominently displayed in the departure area so people can help themselves to

In order for this process to be effective, the 'return box' should be highly visible so that the completed cards can be returned.

- Questionnaires: hard copy questionnaires contain questions on nominated topics and provide structured feedback. These questionnaires are usually developed by management or the marketing department
- On line feedback: if the organisation has a web based presence, there will be a 'Customer comment/Feedback' option on the website. Departing tour group members should be either advised or reminded of this option.

Industry standards usually favour individual feedback over group based feedback so that all tour group members can give honest, genuine feedback without peer pressure.

7.2 Solicit feedback from suppliers, providers and carriers

Introduction

In the same way that feedback from group tour members is an important evaluation tool, feedback from all service providers involved in the tour is part of the quality assurance process and will help the organisation in the management of the tour.

Feedback from carriers, suppliers and providers

Feedback can be gathered either verbally or via a simple questionnaire or a website option and should cover.

Overall business arrangements satisfaction level

- With contractual arrangements:
 - Are the existing arrangements working:
 - Are final numbers provided early enough, or even on time?
 - When confronted with an issue or incidents or even emergency, is prompt support, information and service provided?
- With financial arrangements:
 - Are payment terms working for both parties?
 - Are prices and costs in line with other carriers, suppliers, providers?



Business relationship status

In order to maintain a positive relationship, an honest dialogue needs to take place by conducting:

- Delivery standards and service review:
- Clearly identify problems such as
 - Difficult tour group members constantly late or constantly wandering off
 - Improved communication protocols: quicker 'turn around' time for information sharing, from booking stage to last minute customer requirements changes
 - Difficult tour guide confirming final numbers to suppliers of products and/or services with very short lead time for changes, not giving notice if running late
 - Best course of action to optimise the win/win relationship such as review existing protocols and establish new ones.

7.3 Debrief tour staff

Introduction

All tours, regardless of their duration and the number of tour group members, need to be reviewed on completion. The process of debriefing involves the evaluation of the tour, services provided, and of the tour guides/leaders. The debrief needs to take place shortly after the completion of the tour to avoid forgetting things as everything is still fresh in everyone's mind.

Content of debrief

Debriefing and evaluation is an important component of continuous improvement and quality control and needs to answer the following questions:

How did the tour go?

- What worked well and why?
- Which problems were encountered?
- What action was taken to solve the problem?
- What can be changed, improved to avoid the situation next time?
- What services could be included in the next tour?
- What products could be included in the next tour?



Quality control

- Where all carriers on time and within the schedule timetable?
- Did the services delivered match the expected advertised standards?
- Did the products match the expected advertised standards?

Potential changes

- Policies and procedures, terms and conditions:
 - Should the deposit and full payment be required earlier, later?
 - Should the final number of tour group member be confirmed to all service providers earlier, later?
- Tour itself:
 - Structure: is the tour too short, too long?
 - Are they gap in the tour or is the itinerary too full?
 - It might be better to go to B before A
 - Activities, options should be more varied
 - Not enough or too much free time
 - Is the equipment used effective and useful?
 - It might be better not to offer the tour at the weekend due to the large crowds in some of the venues

- Many tour group members have been on tour before so they might have very good suggestions on how the tour can be improved and their feedback need to be used in the debriefing session. Criticism should always be used in a constructive manner to improve the tour in any way possible.

7.4 Prepare tour report

Introduction

The tour report is a summary of the tour proceedings which includes thoughts and ideas for modifications and improvements. The style of report depends on the organisation and can vary from written form to one line template or verbal report during at a meeting.

Tour report content

A tour report may include, but is not restricted to, issues regarding:

- Itineraries:
 - Too long, too short, suggestions for inclusions
- Transportation:
 - Air conditioning not working
- Coach Driver:
 - Unfriendly attitude
- Activities:
 - Rain the previous day had caused flooding in the activity area
- Commentary:
 - New information previously unknown came to light, some data now outdated
- Delays, unusual events or incidents:
 - Things that occurred which were out of the ordinary
- Feedback from customers:
 - Attach the assembled written feedback forms
- If your host organization does not insist on feedback forms, you should include any verbal comments or feedback you received
- General comments on the tour:
 - This space enables you to provide general comments on your personal opinions of the tour.



It is important to include both the positive and negative sides of the tour.

The information the report contains will be passed on to relevant departments within the host organization for their consideration. The Operations Department will use the tour report to introduce changes to the itinerary or confirm that changes made previously have been accepted by the customers. The Marketing Department will use the tour report to confirm that the promotional material matches the delivered product.

7.5 Share information with suppliers, providers and carriers

Introduction

Information, comments and suggestions should be shared with all providers of services to maintain positive relationship, improve, if required, the delivery of the next tour for all parties concerned and optimise mutual business interests.

Information shared

As the information covers the whole tour, the following organisations will be involved in the information sharing process:

- Carriers from airlines to coach, taxis, boats, cruise liners
- Accommodation establishments
- Restaurants
- Venues such as museums, art galleries, parks
- Outside contractors, if applicable, providing specialised staff for specific activities such as rock climbing, guest speakers, themed night.



The information can come from different sources:

Tour group members' feedback

Whether it is verbal or written feedback, examples:

- Cruise: cabin was very comfortable but noisy
- Restaurants: main course was cold.

Tour debrief

The information from the tour debrief will deal more with the overall quality of service, products supplied; examples:

- The coach arrived 20 minutes late, no valid reason and no notice, and too late to take the tour group tour members out for the whole day of the planned excursion
- Guest speaker as part of an historic tour could not answer some of the tour members questions after his talk.

Tour report

The tour report covers all aspects of the tour inclusive of:

- Tour overall structure
- Routes taken
- All services used
- All equipment used.

In some organisations, the report will also include sales reports.

Those reports enable to provide all concerned parties with quantitative data to measure actual performance against original objectives and determine the profitability of the tour for example.

It is important to remember that negative comments, feedback, experiences are actually opportunities to improve on the tour delivery of products and services.

7.6 Archive information for future reference

Introduction

All documentation relating to the tour must be filed and archived as per the organisation and management requirements.

Archiving system

- **Filing cabinet system:** documents may be filed in a 'filing cabinet' which is a steel cabinet with a series of sliding drawers. Each drawer holds a series of paper swinging files with clearly labelled tabs to identify the content. The swinging files could be arranged in chronological order with the most recent dates for tours at the front
- **Drawer system:** alternatively each tour leader/guide may have a drawer in which documentation for their tours are kept. This would be an appropriate way to file tour reports and customer feedback forms
- **Specific filing:** You may be required to file particular documents in a way that all similar reports from all tours are kept in one place. Ringed binders are often used, whereby each type of report has its designated ringed binder clearly labelled. The report would generally be filed in chronological order. This would be an appropriate way to file sales reports, hazard identification checklists, the lost and found register and incident report forms. These files could be kept in a central location or in the relevant departments
- **Electronic filing:** an electronic filing system could be used for those companies who have such a facility. There are numerous computer software systems developed for effective files storage. Some organizations create their own to cater specifically for their type of industry. You will need to become familiar with any software used by your host organization.



It is important that you adhere to the procedures of the host organization so that all documents provided by all employees are filed in the same way. Filing and storage of documents in an organized and secure way will allow them to be found easily in the future.

You also need to be aware of how long specific documentation is required to be kept by law as it will vary from one country to the other.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

7.1 - 7.2 As part of finalising your extended tour, you are required to:

- Design a brief feedback form to be handed out to the group tour members prior to the completion of the tour
- Design a brief feedback form to be handed to all service and products suppliers in regards to this specific tour.

7.3. While visiting a tour organisation, as part of the list of questions to ask, establish their procedure to debrief staff.

7.4 - 7.5 Referring to your extended tour, list the information you would like the tour staff to include in:

- Their tour report
- The information you will provide to the all suppliers.

7.7 Research how long you need to keep your records as per your country, state legal requirements.

Summary

Finalise tour

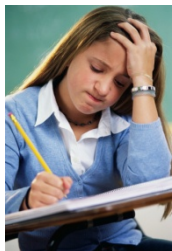
- Solicit feedback from tour group members via:
 - Verbal feedback
 - Written feedback: comment cards or questionnaires
 - Individual or group based
- Solicit feedback from suppliers, providers and carriers to assess:
 - Overall business arrangements satisfaction level
 - Overall business relationship condition
- Debrief tour staff to:
 - Discuss how the tour went:
 - Issues and were they resolved
 - Discuss quality control from all service suppliers
 - Potential changes
- Prepare tour report covering all positive and negatives aspects of the tour
- Share information with suppliers, providers and carriers by:
 - Sharing all qualitative and quantitative information obtained by:
 - Tour group members feedback
 - Tour debrief
 - Tour report
- Archive information for future reference:
 - Select filing system most appropriate to the organisation and the level of technology available
 - Ensure the information is archived in accordance with local legal requirements.

Presentation of written work

1. Introduction

It is important for students to present carefully prepared written work. Written presentation in industry must be professional in appearance and accurate in content. If students develop good writing skills whilst studying, they are able to easily transfer those skills to the workplace.

2. Style



Students should write in a style that is simple and concise. Short sentences and paragraphs are easier to read and understand. It helps to write a plan and at least one draft of the written work so that the final product will be well organised. The points presented will then follow a logical sequence and be relevant. Students should frequently refer to the question asked, to keep 'on track'. Teachers recognise and are critical of work that does not answer the question, or is 'padded' with irrelevant material. In summary, remember to:

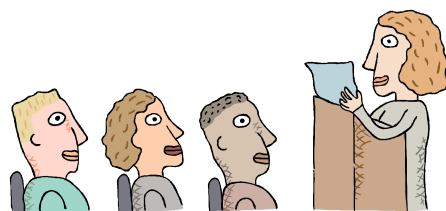
- Plan ahead
- Be clear and concise
- Answer the question
- Proofread the final draft.

3. Presenting Written Work

Types of written work

Students may be asked to write:

- Short and long reports
- Essays
- Records of interviews
- Questionnaires
- Business letters
- Resumes.



Format

All written work should be presented on A4 paper, single-sided with a left-hand margin. If work is word-processed, one-and-a-half or double spacing should be used. Handwritten work must be legible and should also be well spaced to allow for ease of reading. New paragraphs should not be indented but should be separated by a space. Pages must be numbered. If headings are also to be numbered, students should use a logical and sequential system of numbering.

Cover Sheet

All written work should be submitted with a cover sheet stapled to the front that contains:

- The student's name and student number
- The name of the class/unit
- The due date of the work
- The title of the work
- The teacher's name
- A signed declaration that the work does not involve plagiarism.

Keeping a Copy

Students must keep a copy of the written work in case it is lost. This rarely happens but it can be disastrous if a copy has not been kept.

Inclusive language

This means language that includes every section of the population. For instance, if a student were to write 'A nurse is responsible for the patients in her care at all times' it would be implying that all nurses are female and would be excluding male nurses.

Examples of appropriate language are shown on the right:

Mankind	<i>Humankind</i>
Barman/maid	<i>Bar attendant</i>
Host/hostess	<i>Host</i>
Waiter/waitress	<i>Waiter or waiting staff</i>

Recommended reading

Cole, J., 2000, *Coordinating and operating a tour*, Adelaide Institute of TAFE for the Department of Education, Training and Employment, South Australia

Frost, W., 2004, *Travel and tour management*, Pearson Education Australia, Frenchs Forest, NSW

O'Shannessy, V., 2009 (2nd ed'n), *The road to tourism: skills for the new professional*, Pearson Education Australia, Frenchs Forest, NSW

Pastorelli, J., 2002, *Enriching the experience: an interpretive approach to tour guiding*, Pearson Education, Frenchs Forest, NSW

Tourism Queensland, 2001, *Tour operator tool kit*, Queensland Tourism, Brisbane

Van der Wagen, L 2010, *Events and Tourism Essentials*, Pearson Education Australia

Trainee evaluation sheet

Manage and execute a detailed tour itinerary

The following statements are about the competency you have just completed.

Please tick the appropriate box	Agree	Don't Know	Do Not Agree	Does Not Apply
There was too much in this competency to cover without rushing.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of the competency seemed relevant to me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency was at the right level for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I got enough help from my trainer.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The amount of activities was sufficient.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency allowed me to use my own initiative.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My training was well-organised.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer had time to answer my questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understood how I was going to be assessed.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was given enough time to practice.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer feedback was useful.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enough equipment was available and it worked well.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The activities were too hard for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐

The best things about this unit were:

The worst things about this unit were:

The things you should change in this unit are:

Trainee self-assessment checklist

As an indicator to your Trainer/Assessor of your readiness for assessment in this unit please complete the following and hand to your Trainer/Assessor.

Manage and execute a detailed tour itinerary

		Yes	No*
Element 1: Prepare for tour itinerary			
1.1	Identify the requirements in the itinerary	☐	☐
1.2	Clarify requirements relating to the itinerary	☐	☐
1.3	Plan tour in accordance with briefing information	☐	☐
1.4	Identify tour-related risks	☐	☐
1.5	Develop contingency plans for risks	☐	☐
1.6	Confirm reserved tour components	☐	☐
Element 2: Conduct departure-related activities			
2.1	Greet tour group members	☐	☐
2.2	Complete outstanding customer details	☐	☐
2.3	Distribute tour-related information	☐	☐
2.4	Provide tour briefing	☐	☐
2.5	Provide last-minute confirmations, payments and booking details to suppliers, providers and carriers	☐	☐
Element 3: Brief tour staff			
3.1	Provide tour details to tour staff	☐	☐
3.2	Provide resources to support tour	☐	☐
Element 4: Liaise with external industry colleagues throughout the tour			
4.1	Liaise with industry personnel to facilitate tour implementation	☐	☐
4.2	Request assistance, where appropriate	☐	☐
4.3	Make on tour agreements with organisations to respond to issues arising	☐	☐

		Yes	No*
Element 5: Manage on tour itinerary			
5.1	Facilitate conduct of the tour schedule	☐	☐
5.2	Advise tour staff regarding issues arising	☐	☐
5.3	Re-plan itinerary as required	☐	☐
5.4	Maintain contact with those responsible for resolving on tour issues	☐	☐
5.5	Advise industry colleagues regarding tour changes	☐	☐
5.6	Maintain regular contact with tour group	☐	☐
5.7	Monitor the tour area	☐	☐
Element 6: Deal with unexpected events			
6.1	Initiate contingency planning actions	☐	☐
6.2	Support tour group leaders/guides	☐	☐
6.3	Research and suggest additional action to be taken	☐	☐
6.4	Make arrangements in response to identified emergencies	☐	☐
6.5	Handle media interest	☐	☐
6.6	Amend tour itinerary as required	☐	☐
Element 7: Finalise tour			
7.1	Solicit feedback from tour group members	☐	☐
7.2	Solicit feedback from suppliers, providers and carriers	☐	☐
7.3	Debrief tour staff	☐	☐
7.4	Prepare tour report	☐	☐
7.5	Share information with suppliers, providers and carriers	☐	☐
7.6	Archive information for future reference	☐	☐

Statement by Trainee:

I believe I am ready to be assessed on the following as indicated above:

Signed: _____

Date: _____

Note:

For all boxes where a **No*** is ticked, please provide details of the extra steps or work you need to do to become ready for assessment.

William
Angliss
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